



The Mighty E1!

This small sized unique camera is able to shoot in 4K, has lenses which are interchangeable as well as packs number of features. Read all here: <http://dgit.in/e14kcamera>

GoPro launches its app

GoPro is working on a new smartphone app that should make it easier to use, view, edit and share your footage right after it's been shot. Read here: dgit.in/goprosapp

Feature

select a genre of your choice, or search for all genres. The curated feed displays a long, categorised list, which includes 13 categories such as New Music, Hot Tracks, Recent Releases, and more.

Then there's an entire list of recent music



Automated playlists feed

trends curated according to recent tracks played by you. The Apple Music Editors features 15 sections of hand-selected playlists, for all the genres that you've selected while setting up Apple Music. In the Bollywood section, we found three tabs, Featured, Playlists, and Connect. There's also a feed by Apple's curators, "We're loving these". Connect will give you feeds from Indian artists: we had Sunidhi Chauhan and Amit Trivedi's choices listed when we checked in.

The Curators tab gives you a list of all that Apple's music curators are listening to, where you are least likely to come across Indian tracks. Apple Music's Activities include BBQing, Breaking Up, Running, Working Out, and 15 other activities. Select each activity, and the music feed for each of them will have a balance of various tracks among the genres you have chosen. Activities will also have genre-based sub-playlists. For instance, Working Out had a playlist to work out with Bollywood.

Radio: live music and pre-curated lists

The radio tab's first and largest tile is reserved for Beats. Other featured channels are All-City, Pop Hits, On the Floor, The Mixtape, Soundsystem, and Charting Now. Bollywood and Tamil fans have entire stations to themselves. There is a large variety of tracks from which Apple chooses the mix, although we noticed more of the recent Bol-

lywood tracks on radio, than the older ones.

In radio, you can see the next track while playing one. There is, however, no playlist shown. While playing, you can share the station or song. You can also start a station based on a playing track, which will curate itself based on the type of track you were playing. You can also download the track to your device to hear it offline, or see it on the iTunes store. We did find a large number of repetitions, though, strewn across an extensive number of playlists created by the platform for Indian music. The curation, however, is good, with a seamless flow evident across all tracks.

Connect: stream through your favourite artist's day at work

Apple Music's "Connect" feature has a Twitter-esque timeline, with various artists posting work-in-progress photographs annotated with captions, which can either be liked or commented upon. We found the Salim-Sulaiman duo sharing a photograph from their Saturday night concert, Anoushka Shankar sharing a snippet of an upcoming live home studio performance, and Arijit Singh sharing his rehearsal photograph. It's a nice, intuitive feature that may interest a lot of devoted Indian music listeners. Internationally, we found the Red Hot Chili Peppers gearing up in the studio, and their bassist with a smiling face and a broken arm.

Connect is a great place for fans to get an inside view into the world of music. It is a stream of stories by musicians.

A few things we didn't like

First, the entire confusion about having to sign up with a credit card on file. While it does make sense if you're planning to subscribe in future anyway, not all might have such a long-term plan. Although you can disable auto-pay to ensure that no money is deducted from your account, this doesn't aid functionality. Additionally, most of the young crowd in India uses Debit cards for their payments, and Apple Music doesn't accept anything except Credit cards. This might detract a lot of people right at the onset: something clearly not favourable.

Secondly, search options within Apple Music seem slightly impaired. Quite often, we found it rather difficult to spot artists, or

specific albums. Apple Music had problems, and often took time, to find prominent albums and tracks. Although navigation and interface are fairly smooth, there are times where Apple Music felt a bit too full of options: so much that you might even get a bit confused with what to find and where. This, however, is not a problem, per se. It would be dependant on personal usage.

Summing up the first experience

Apple Music has not only arrived in India, it has provided India with an extensive selection of music across a number of regions and timespan. We found Mohammed Rafi and R.D. Burman's collections that go



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more than four decades back, and current generation's Arijit Singh and Ankit Tiwari, who also post updates via Connect. You can download and listen to tracks offline: an important feature in India owing to slower connection speeds. Apple has synced the local music library that you have with Apple Music, so all the tracks and albums you download can be instantly synced and organised once you open the 'My Music' tab.

To sum it all up, Apple has provided an extensive base of Indian tracks on Apple Music, and even focused on regional Indian music. With a large number of playlists curated by listening choice, and pre-programmed ones for different times and moods, Apple Music has every capability to strike the right chord among Indian listeners. We wait for Apple Music's Android version, and hope that most of the features, clutter-free interface and smooth functionality will be carried over to it too. **4**